Everyone Says to Me:

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/71391576.

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Explicit

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

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Background Relationships, Minor Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Minor Mermista/Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Flashbacks, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Alternate Universe - Modern: No Powers, Human Catra (She-Ra), Latina Catra (She-Ra), Friends to Lovers, Suicidal Thoughts, only briefly i promise, Alcohol Abuse/Alcoholism, Angst and Fluff and Smut

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Everyone Says to Me:

by Dr_Peak

Summary

That shimmering ponytail illuminates everyone on the dance floor. Except, there is no ponytail and no golden light. It's all a figment of her imagination. She's being haunted by a golden ghostly visage darting around corners and shining like a burning star.

or:

Catra and Adora have a slight falling out when the latter announces they will be leaving to join the Peace Corps. Now two years have passed, and their lives may collide once more.

TWs: Suicidal Ideation (briefly, mainly like passive thoughts),
Alcoholism (lightly, if it can be such a thing),
A few mentions of vomit.

Chapter 1: Old Memories / There's So Much You Don't See

Chapter Notes

Note: *** = change in time, within the same day.
Linebreak = change in time to a new day.
Any other time changes are explicitly stated.

Listen along with the official playlist!

Some songs are referenced, some just felt right but aren't exactly an explicit reference, and others are diegetic.
The first song is the inspiration for this entire thing.
(The playlist spans all five chapters to be clear, so listen as they pop up)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra you're so strong.

"What did you say?" Catra squints at the pink menace in front of her.

"I said, you're so wrong," Glimmer scowls, "In what world is that a healthy way to spend your nights?"

"Psht. You're the one who came knocking at my door and started getting all up in my business, and now you're judging me? Pretty rude in my opinion."

"Sorry for caring! It's been *awhile* now, and it turns out you've been drowning your feelings this whole time. Is that why you're always 'busy' in the evening? We try to include you. We know it hasn't been easy." Glimmer says, crossing her arms.

"Don't tell *me* how long it's been and don't act like you know anything I've been feeling. I don't get why you're suddenly so

interested in this. Maybe I just need a drink in the evening and a shitty movie, since when was that illegal?”

“Every night? You’re basically an alcoholic at this point. *Bow saw your recycling bin.* Has it always been this bad or did it get worse recently?”

Bow had been over to help her put together a table, only because she ran into him at the store, and he had insisted. She could’ve put it together. Probably.

“My recycling is none of Bow’s business, nor yours,” Catra hisses, “Is that what this is? Some kinda shitty intervention? You’re a few people short, y'know?” She gestures at the empty room. Empty is very fitting for her these days.

“Look, I just wanted to come by and check on you because… well… I just *did* after hearing that from Bow.”

“Uh huh, well that was what, a week ago? You sure took your time.” Catra says watching Glimmer’s face get red.

“You are a grown woman! I’m not your mother but I am a friend, or at least I thought I was, so I gave you some time but I was still concerned!”

Catra just rolls her eyes and stares at Glimmer, who looks like she may kill her before the alcohol can.

“For how well you had this under wraps I’m shocked you’d leave your bin full like that. Not exactly a cry for help when you immediately fight me.” Exactly what makes it a cry for help, Sparkles.

“Then I guess it’s not huh, maybe next time you and wonder boy mind your own business. It’s pretty late, I bet he’s missing you,” Catra walks towards her door, “I’ll see you at Scorpia’s.”

“Don’t think this is the end of things, Catra.” Glimmer scoffs, following her.

"Yeah, yeah. Go on back to your perfect dream world." She opens the door and shoos Glimmer out, closing the door behind her. She sighs and slides down to the floor. Why would Glimmer just drop by like that anyways. She wasn't stupid enough *or drunk enough* to buy that intervention excuse. If it wasn't an intervention there's only one real thing that would have her dropping by unannounced, but Catra didn't want to think about that right now. "Fuck. I need a drink." She rises to her feet and heads over to the fridge. "Nothing? Really?" She groans, looking inside and seeing that the only drinks are not the kind she needs right now. Hell it's still early enough to put something nice on and go get a drink.

***

Exiting her apartment she feels a familiar clenching in her throat. She could have sworn she saw that blond ponytail turning down the hallway, but when she rounded the corner, there was no sign of anyone. It was a dead-end aside from a couple apartments and she hadn't heard any doors or locks. Get a grip. *Get a drink.* You're fine. You're strong. You can stand on your own just fine. You don't need any *aid*. You've made it this far, this long. You're not a charity case. *Get out there and prove it.*

***

"—Good luck with your life!" Catra shouts at her phone, ending the voicemail with a *hicc*. As she returns her phone to her back pocket, it happens again. That shimmering ponytail illuminates everyone on the dance floor—except there is no ponytail and no golden light. It's all a figment of her imagination. She's being haunted by a golden ghostly visage darting around corners and shining like a burning star. Why so many of them? Why tonight?

What day even is it? She fumbles with her glass, nearly knocking it over. Guess that's my sign to call it a night, she thinks. Maybe that asshole will stop mentally tormenting me, by the time I'm home. She pays for her tab and pushes away from the bar. Just as she was about to be out the door, she hears the song change.

It was a bad idea

Calling you up

Was such a bad idea

'Cause now I'm even more lost

Could the universe be any more cliche? It's actually nauseating. Maybe that was only partially the universe's fault, she thinks before quickly ducking into a nearby alley.

***

Damn must've taken a wrong turn somewhere. All these streets look the same, but *that* is unmistakable to her. The park, her favorite park, *their* favorite park. If she goes into that park she'll just be torturing herself, and she knows it. Yet she can't stop herself. It's like a gravitational pull.

The closer she gets, the further in she gets, the more she sees them. The golden ghosts running around, some shorter, accompanied by their own red ghosts. They run and play, they sit on picnic blankets, they lay under trees together, they—

“Stop it!” she gasps, clutching her head. She may be drunk but her brain isn’t as clever as it thinks, she knows exactly what these are. She’s reliving memories of when things were happy, or certainly not like they are now. Innocent, naive, young memories. If only she had known, if only they both had known. Known what she would do.

Just as she reaches one of their favorite spots, a ring of trees, perfect to lay under, to her side she sees an unusually dull, yet unmistakably golden ghost. She’s so sick of it. Golden light in her face, ruining any chance at enjoying things. Things that she deserves to enjoy.

“Fuck off, you apparition, this is my spot! Go back to my memories!” Catra growls, roughly shoving the figure, and beginning to storm away. She freezes, slowly realizing what may have just happened. She shoved it. As in made contact with a real body. Unless she was actually unconscious, she had just touched something real, *someone real.* She can’t bear it. Every instinct in her body is screaming at her to run. Don’t turn around. Don’t, Don’t, Don’t—

“Is that you, Catra?”

Two years and nine months ago.

“Catra, c’mon, if it weren’t safe would they keep doing this every year?” Adora rests her hands on her hips, leaning in towards her.

“That means nothing. All it takes is one high carnie for a bloodbath, and there’s no way those guys aren’t on something. Especially since it's way too early in the day, they *must* be on

stimulants. I sure as shit wish I was.” She is not a morning person, unless that morning is simply laying in a sunbeam.

“Catra! No energy drinks! You get jittery.” Adora admonishes. She’s making that stupid face she does when she knows she’s right. So annoying. “Anyway, let’s see, there have been, hmm,” She looks up, a hand on her chin, like she’s thinking, “Exactly zero bloodbaths so far.”

”Why did you make me watch all those Final Destination movies with you last month?” she groans, “That's all I can think about now, with this type of thing.” They had hunkered down one weekend and marathoned all of the movies. She thought she would be desensitized after seeing all the increasingly absurd rube goldbergs of death, but instead she’s become more afraid of possible death traps. It's all stupid Adora’s fault. That dumb grin gets her into a lot of trouble.

“C’mon~ we’ll get there early if we leave now, we can do a couple rides or games, then go chill at our spot before dark. There’s probably a good view on some of those rides.” She mimes taking a photo, even making a clicking noise. Catra stares at her, thinking for a long moment, deciding any possible bloodbath would be worth the time with Adora.

“I don’t even have a proper camera, but fine. You’re lugging the blanket around, though.” She swears Adora’s tooth sparkles as she grins at Catra.

“I got a backpack for a reason.” She gives Catra what she assumes is meant to be a suave look, with a raised eyebrow. This woman is such an absolute dork, yet Catra can’t get enough, she never could, and never will.

“Alright, Casanova, let's go.” Catra winks at her.

“Casanova— I’m not— That wasn’t—” Adora blushes profusely, looking away. She’s so easy to mess with, so Catra takes every

opportunity she can. It’s not like Adora would ever actually think of her like that, so she might as well enjoy what she can get.

“Do I have to do everything?” Catra grins, grabbing ahold of Adora's hand, pulling her along.

***

“Oh my god, I can’t believe I let you talk me into this thing!” Catra clutches the safety rail above her legs. She is actually going to die, and it’s because of this beautiful blond moron.

“*I* can’t believe you’ve managed to hide the fact you’ve never been on a ferris wheel from me this long! They’re perfectly safe, although this is my first time on one that's only a chair like this…” Adora’s face momentarily looks unsure before returning to its usual beaming state.

“WHAT!” Catra screams at Adora, her jaw hanging slack. Adora laughs, causing the chair to rock back and forth, making creaking noises.

“STOP, ADORA! STOP!” Catra pleads with her. This is what she gets for her one sided teasing. She flew too close to the sun, and now she’s going to fall to her death with Adora.

“Catra you’re making a scene.” Adora is visibly holding back laughter.

“DO I LOOK LIKE I GIVE A DAMN?” Adora’s expression suddenly goes very soft, concern forming in her eyes.

“Hey, it’s okay, we’re all right, I would never let anything happen to you.” She reaches over to rub Catra’s shoulder, “We can leave after this.” In that moment she really did believe her, if Adora said so then nothing could happen to her. Adora…

“No, we don’t have to go because of me, ‘Dor. We just got here.” Catra is still scared but somehow Adora’s assurances have numbed it plenty. She feels safer now.

“Please, let’s go after this.” Adora looks like she’s glowing as she says it. Her blue eyes filled with concern and passion.

“Okay… only because you want to.” Catra feels like she’s ruining everything again, but at the same time it seems like Adora would be more pained to stay. Pained for her.

“But… we can still get funnel cake right?” Adora asks, her stomach grumbling in anticipation.

***

Days like these really do make the never ending struggle of life worth it. The sun is shining, she’s soaking in all of its rays, after an *adventurous* afternoon. A soft blanket beneath her, and of course, the one person who really makes it all worth it. Adora is humming an annoyingly fitting song, like the massive dork she is, but it is Saturday and they are in the park after all.

“You know how I want to help people?” Adora abruptly cuts off her humming.

Catra slowly cracks open her eyes, raising her hand to shield them from the sun as she turns her head. The sun is bright behind Adora, giving her outline a golden glow. Her blond hair looks absolutely magical, down from its usual ponytail, blowing gently in the breeze. And those blue eyes, they’re radiant, like oceans filled to the brim with stars. She wants to swim in them. It all feels like a dream, and she doesn’t want to wake up. But that's the thing about dreams, they end.

“A couple months ago I applied to the Peace Corps, and the other day I found out they accepted me. I’ll be leaving in like 6 months.” She stops to take a deep breath, “I’ll be gone for a little over two years.” Catra’s heart sinks. Her perfect dream world begins to melt away. It isn’t ending though, Catra can tell, it’s becoming a nightmare instead. Adora’s leaving her. It was inevitable, she could never be enough.

“Catra?” Adora cocks her head, looking at her expectantly.

“Sorry, the sun was in my eyes.” Catra blinks slowly at her before turning away, “Don’t you think you should focus on helping yourself first?”

“What? I’m doing just fine, I don’t see what there is to focus on.” Adora says, surprised.

“Maybe it’s exactly that, Adora. You *aren’t* doing fine. You’re still chasing after other people, trying to be some noble hero. What about yourself, the things that matter in *your* life?”

“So, it’s bad for me to want to help people?”

“That's not what I'm saying and you know that!” Catra growls, turning to lock eyes with Adora. “All you do is deflect, it’s actually your strongest skill.” She sighs, “Now listen to this: ‘My wellbeing doesn’t matter if I’m helping others, fulfilling what others want.’ See, it sounds stupid because it is. You’ve always treated yourself like number two in your own life, Adora.” *And I’ll never be that important to you, will I?*

”I do not value others over myself. I just… need to feel useful. Like I’m doing something that makes a difference. That doesn’t mean I’m broken.” Adora looks down at her hands for a moment, before returning her gaze to Catra.

“I never said you were broken. We’ve known each other for how many years? I think I’ve got a pretty good read on you by now. Plus how could I not be able to know what you’re thinking considering how much I—” She bites her lip and looks away.

“You’re one of the most pure and good people I’ve ever met and I would bet on you being in the top five worldwide, but you care too much about people who aren’t you, Adora.” What Catra really wants to add is *‘Would you ever care about us that much?’* She knows it's selfish, but if Adora is set on helping others why not do something that will help herself too. She wants so badly to ask her to stay. Beg her even, but she can’t, she won't let herself. Why make this harder.

“Catra, look at me.” Adora says, and she does, seeing Adora’s eyes watering. She realizes tears are rolling down her own cheeks. Don’t stop now. She’ll never have the time for you. There will always be something or someone in the way. You’re a lost cause, that’s why she helps everyone else. She’s only stayed around this long out of some pity.

“Go live out your goddamn noble journey, but I’m not just gonna sit around twiddling my thumbs waiting for you, Adora.” Catra chokes out.

“Wait for me?” She hates seeing Adora like this, her beautiful eyes should never cry like this, but she can’t keep torturing herself either. They both need to be free.

“I hate you, Adora… I hate myself… I hate how much I love you. I hate that you’ll always be more concerned with other people’s goals and perceptions. You need to care about yourself like that.” *You need to care about me like that.* “I can’t stand by and watch you work yourself to death like you’re just a tool.” Catra grimaces, at Adora or herself, she isn't sure.

“Love… Catra—” Adora reaches out, but Catra stands up. She looks down at Adora, no longer being comforted by that beautiful glow from before. Everything feels so cold suddenly. Is that what life will feel like from now on?

“This isn’t some shitty ultimatum I’m just telling you, I’m not waiting two years just to lose even more when you inevitably extend as much as possible to help more people, which you will

do. Then even after that, who knows where you'll run off to, who you'll drop everything to help."

"Catra, we can figure things out, I didn't realize—"

"That's the problem, Adora. You don't realize. You never do. Especially not about yourself. Doing shit like this is how you neglect yourself, and it affects others, Adora. It might come back to haunt you." Consider how much it will hurt me, how much it already is hurting me. "Good luck, Adora." Catra wipes her eyes and starts to walk away, fighting every instinct telling her to turn around. She knows it has to be like this.

Two years and three months ago.

"You have to go, tomorrow." Glimmer says staring daggers at Catra. This pink menace always manages to corner her, and talks like she knows everything.

"I don't *have* to do anything." Catra spits out, meeting Glimmers glare with her own. She's so stubborn it drives her mad.

"She's your childhood best friend, you have to see her off! It's a party too, it'll be fun!" Glimmer adds, trying a different angle.

Best friend. She hasn't been that since that day at the park. Not like she could have ever been more, so maybe this really is for the best.

"She won't miss me at the party if she's leaving everything behind."

“Fucking grow up, Catra! You’re so impossible sometimes! You blow up at her, confess your love, storm off, and then avoid her at practically every chance you get.

“Confess my love!? She's been telling everyone I confessed my love like some sad puppy dog that would be lost without her?!” And Adora’s right, except she doesn’t beg. If Adora wants to abandon her, she’s not going to grovel.

“From where I’m standing…”

“Drop. It.” Catra growls.

“As if. You’re breaking her heart, Catra.”

“Well… I don’t know how she expected me to react. Not exactly a fucking cheery little thing to drop, all of a sudden. ‘Hey, Catra I’m leaving for two years to fuel my self-worth complex, bye!’”

“You’re being completely irrational! She told you first because of how much you matter to her! It's a scary thing to leave everyone and everything you know! Then you drop your own cheery little confession before running away!”

“WELL, MAYBE— I deserve to be a little irrational right now… I can’t help how I feel, and if I really matter that much—“ her breath catches, “If I *mattered* so much and it’s so scary, why is she doing this?” *To us?*

“Oh, I don’t know, maybe if you talked to her sometime during the last six months or so, you’d have a better idea.”

“I can’t… I can’t see her, her face, her hair, her *eyes,* Glimmer... She’s leaving, it's what she wants, but…”

“But?” Glimmer leans in.Catra looks down at her feet.

“Where's the party?” she whispers, barely audible. Glimmer smiles at that.

“Scorpia is hosting at 6:00. Her apartment is the biggest and it's the best distance for everyone. Does this mean I can tell them you’re coming?”

“No, it *doesn’t*.” Catra furrows her brow.

“Try to stop me.” Glimmer says smugly, reaching for her phone.

“No one will find your body, Sparkles.” Catra states like it's a fact.

“You’re right it's better as a surprise just in case you’re gonna bail again which would break Adora’s heart, and I won’t let you do that.”

“You can’t stop me from doing anything.” Catra growls, clenching a fist, which Glimmer notices.

“Well, I guess I’ve worn out my welcome. I look forward to seeing you tomorrow. I can show myself out.” Glimmer walks to the door and as she begins to open it, Catra calls out.

“Glimmer.” She stops and turns to face Catra once more, but when Catra opens her mouth to speak again nothing comes out. She doesn’t even know what she’s feeling anymore, and certainly can’t express it in words. Glimmer simply gives her a knowing look and nods before closing the door behind her. Catra stumbles to bed because suddenly she can hardly keep herself standing, and she might as well try to rest now despite knowing how sleepless her night will be.

Two years and 29 days ago.

Catra is standing outside the apartment building, facing the steps. She really shouldn't have agreed to come. She can't do this, but she should, right? She's all but burned the bridge, and now she's about to walk across it? Don't be stupid, Catra, you're just going to make things more painful for the both of you. *Turn around and leave*. *You'll just ruin the party anyways*. It's all just too much. Her head is pounding, her breathing is heavy, she can barely think. *Run*.

Just as she starts to back away, the door swings inwards. Adora and Bow are standing there, with differing levels of shocked expressions. Adora looks like she might cry, Catra wasn't sure if it was from happiness or sadness, Bow looks, well, uncomfortable, and Catra, she doesn't even want to imagine what she looks like right now.

"Oh— I… Uh— Forgot my phone! Yeah!" Bow exclaims while exaggeratedly patting his pockets, before turning to run back inside, leaving the two of them on their own. Seemingly neither of them knows what to say, as they stand there in silence.

"I take it from those reactions, Glimmer didn't tell everyone I was coming?" Catra asks, and Adora slowly nods after a moment, clearly trying to calm herself. "Well, good. I was serious about killing her." Catra scoffs, looking at her nails. She was not prepared for this, she was about to leave and then this big blond moron just had to come outside. Why was she outside? "Wait, where were you two going? Isn't the party happening now?" Catra asks, glancing up at Adora, before quickly breaking eye contact.

"Uh, well, turns out all the chips are actually pickle flavored, we somehow missed that, so, um, Bow and I were gonna go out to get some regular chips and a few other things." Adora's hands are twitching, grabbing at her shorts. She's never known what to do with her hands.

"Doing a snack run for your own party? Typical." Of course Adora is running an errand for her party, *during* her own party.

“It's not like I thought— knew you were coming.” Adora stammers, looking at Catra.

“Because you think I would throw a tantrum and ruin everything if I knew you left on an errand at your own party?” she furrows her brow.

“Because I would’ve wanted you to come with me.” Adora responds softly, soft like her hair, her skin… *Stop it.*

”Huh, so I’m still good enough to take along for snack runs…” Catra glares at Adora. It pains her, it really does, to look at that face with anything other than love, but she can’t pretend any longer.

“Catra, please come with me, we can talk about… everything, away from the party.” She’s like a siren, singing a beautiful song that Catra knows will only lead to pain.

“Fine.” Catra crosses her arms. Might as well get this all over with.

“Let me just tell them I’m still getting chips.” Adora fumbles taking out her phone then taps away for a few moments before returning it to her pocket. “You ready?” she asks, turning to Catra.

“Ready as ever, Princess.” Catra gulps and looks away. It had just slipped out. She hasn’t used that nickname since, well, before that dreadful day. She hasn’t said it since she was *happy* and for a moment there she thought she was.

“Then, uh, we should probably get going.” Adora responds.

“Yeah…” They start walking and Catra stops herself as she almost reaches for Adora’s hand. *Six months Catra, you’ve made it this long, what’s wrong with you?*

”So, how have you been?” Adora asks, scratching her neck and glancing over at Catra.

“Just peachy. Ask me about the weather, why don't you?” Catra laughs, despite knowing she isn’t making any conversation attempts herself.

“Okay, be like that. Is this all really about me or is it about you? None of it makes sense.” Adora is clearly frustrated, and for some reason that makes Catra mad.

“You’re fucking leaving, Adora, leaving everyone, *leaving me*. You’re chasing after some complex fueled high, when there’s more than enough for you here.” Catra exclaims, feeling blood rush to her face in anger.

“You mean, you’re here, so it should be enough.” Adora adds, looking at Catra like she just hit a bullseye.

“Don’t psychoanalyze me.” Catra scowls at her. Who does she think she is?

“What was it you did to me before storming off, and avoiding me for six months? At least you can fight back, since I’m not running off.” Catra grimaces hearing the last part. Adora might have a point, but that doesn’t matter. None of it changes anything.

”This was stupid, I should’ve known better.” Catra stops walking, and puts a hand to her forehead.

“You don’t get to shut down now, Catra.”

“WHY NOT?!” Catra cries out, “I’ve never gotten what I wanted. Now the only good thing about my shitty life is leaving.“

“I may deflect but you sure as hell try to blow up everything around yourself so you don’t get your hopes up. I get it, Catra, you think I’m not scared? I’m fucking horrified, and its been so much worse since that day. I thought… I thought you were the one person in *my* life I could count on to be there no matter what.”

Catra stays silent, looking away from Adora, who quickly approaches her. She puts her hands on Catra's shoulders.

"Catra, you're so strong, the strongest person I know, this doesn't have to end because I'm leaving. We could… start something new…"

Catra looks at Adora and whispers, "Just… shut up." She can't stop herself, she feels her head moving. Her hands are reaching up, landing on each side of Adora's jaw, pulling her in. Her eyes are closed, and when their lips touch, it's better than anything she ever imagined. If they never stop then Adora will never leave, they'll be together, but this can't go on forever. This will be her happiest memory yet also the saddest because she'll never feel this again. Catra pulls away, slowly they both open their eyes. Adora's cheeks are so red, her face so beautiful. So… far away. Unobtainable. *She isn't good enough for her.*

Catra takes a deep breath, "Adora Gray, I love you… which is why I can never see you again." Catra steps back, and suddenly starts to rush away. Adora is left in shock, surely making a face that would destroy Catra's heart and maybe even stop this all.

"Then fucking go! Who gives a shit about my feelings, whether or not I'm in love with you too!" Adora shouts, causing Catra to stop in place. She feels frozen but she has to move. She can't just stand here. Catra takes a step forward. It would be so easy to dart into the road right now or maybe a car will veer off the road. Maybe, just maybe, she could be struck by lightning. Those would all make things so much easier.

"This bell can't be unrung, Adora. After that day in the park, we were doomed." Catra says solemnly.

"If you believe that, then there really is no hope." Adora sounds so defeated, so sad. Catra doesn't know what to do, so she runs. She doesn't know where she's going, just away.

Chapter End Notes

Y'all I am so excited to be posting this. It's been nearly three months since I started. This is my first attempt at a "real" fic, so feedback is greatly appreciated.

:)

(I'm screaming internally, in a good way.)

Chapter 2: New Beginnings? / You Stupid Fuck

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Present Time

Catra feels a hand on her shoulder and whips around, shoving it away.

"Get off me!" In her haste she slips on a loose patch of dirt, and sends herself face first into something hard and warm. It smells so familiar, it can't really be her right?

"Woah, are you alright?" she feels two big hands holding her. She pushes herself away, so she can see who's really in front of her. Catra gasps, it really is her. Her unmistakably beautiful blue eyes, her blond hair. She's here, and she cut her hair? *More importantly, why is she here?*

"What did'ja do to your hair 'Dor— Adora, it's all gone." Is all she can manage. Adora must've done it herself, a shorter shaggy cut, yet distinctly Adora still. The lack of hair did make it feel like she's talking to a completely different person, maybe she is, it's been two years. Adora is clearly surprised that's the first thing she says to her.

"Well, uh, long hair takes too much time and resources to maintain, plus it felt good in the heat. I was in a desert, y'know, but wow, you've really grown yourself a mane, huh?" She scratches the back of her head, eyes glancing around.

"Yeah… it just felt right or something, but… you're here now?" Catra all but whispers her question.

"Yeah… I… I'm done." Done? Does she mean… Adora clears her throat and takes a deep breath, "All the time I spent these last two years doing what I thought I needed, there was something missing, and I just couldn't understand what. My whole life I thought I needed to make myself useful, but it wasn't working. The only times I felt relief was when… I was with you. There never was something missing, *someone* was missing." Adora gives her a pained look, like she hadn't tried to stop Catra from pushing her away.

"Adora, I…" She tries to speak, but nothing else will come out, nothing *good*. A few silent moments later Adora continues, "After that day at the park, I barely saw you, everything was so confusing. Then I had my party… I was mad, I was… in love, I was feeling so many things, and I thought leaving to make myself useful would fix things, but I know I was wrong now." *Was* in love, of course, Adora doesn't love her anymore, she'd be stupid to love her still.

"Well if only somebody warned you about that." Catra grunts, looking down and kicking a rock.

"Catra." Adora says sternly. Catra looks up to find those intense blue eyes boring into her. She could get lost in those beautiful eyes, but she can't, not now. Painfully, she tears her gaze away, looking down at her lips. Oh no, her lips. It's been so long since she was this close to them. They look so soft— *snap out of it!*

"Adora." Catra mimics back. Trying to distract herself, she kicks another rock and stumbles, managing to regain her balance.

"You look like you're gonna fall over, is this, uhm, a regular night for you?" Adora looks concerned now, more so than usual. It makes her stomach churn.

"Why's it fuckin' matter, a girl can't have a couple drinks in the evening?" Catra growls, getting defensive. She's been back for two seconds and she's already judging me, typical.

“A couple drinks? You’re pretty fucked up right now, I know you well enough to see that much.” God, she looks so sure of herself, like she’s some hero here to save me.

“Oh here comes my knight in shining armor, two years late.” Catra chides.

“For fucks sake, Catra, I’m trying to do a good thing here.” Oh, she looks mad, bushy eyebrows furrowed, that little vein on her forehead, pursed lips— *don’t look at her lips*.

“And how's your track record with that?” Catra scoffs, focusing on Adora’s nose, the only safe space she can direct her gaze.

“I’d almost forgotten what it's like when you get this way. We can settle our business later, now, I’m taking you home. No arguments. Same place?”

“Yeah…” Catra concedes. Adora offers her arm, and Catra hesitantly links her own, swallowing her pride and prioritizing not falling on her face. “Back in the country after two years, and your first thought is to skulk around a park, looking for drunks to take home?”

“Wha— I wasn’t skulking, and I’m not some… sicko! I’m just getting you home safely.” Adora exclaims, clearly flustered. Two years and she can push her buttons all the same.

“I’m just saying the innocent ones always turn out to be the freaks.” She grins, hugging ever so closer to Adora.

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“Welp, here we are.” Catra unlocks her door, walks in, and Adora follows. “Are you satisfied, my noble protector? I made it home safely.”

“You were a mess out there, I can't leave you alone like this Catra. I'm staying.”

“Jesus, what's the point of the third amendment, well at least make yourself useful and… clean… or something.” Catra grumbles as she closes the door.

“You need to drink water.” Adora walks to the cabinet, and grabs a glass to fill. She does so and leaves it on the counter next to Catra, “Seriously it’s important to hydrate, drink up.”

“Sure, whatever, Mom, what I really need is to take these shoes off.” she complains, beginning to lift a foot up to take it off while standing.

“I don’t think that’s the best—” before Adora can finish her annoying warning, Catra feels herself start to lose balance. She’s falling and she’s going to hit her head on the counter. Instead she feels a familiar warmth for the second time that night. Adora had rushed in and caught her. They both sink to the ground. They’re holding onto each other. She's still here helping me after everything, *after what I did*. Catra’s eyes begin to well up with tears. She doesn’t want to show this side of her to anyone, but if not Adora then who? She starts breaking down crying, burying her face in Adora’s neck.

“I’m so sorry, ‘Dor, it wasn’t supposed to be like this,” she sobs, clinging to Adora, “I was so wrong, I can’t take it anymore…”

“Shh, shh… it's okay… I'm here, I know… I know… it's gonna be okay…” Adora whispers, gently raising a hand to caress Catra’s head.

“You know… I've thought about…” her voice shudders, “Things are bad, ‘Dor, since you left, since I drove you away.”

“You didn’t drive me away. I had made up my mind.” Adora whispers softly. Catra clutches the back of Adora’s shirt.

“Please don't leave me, Adora.” Catra whimpers, and so Adora pulls her in closer.

“I won't, I won’t leave you.” She shakily raises her head to look at Adora, she’s crying… crying for me…

“I'll never leave you, Catra… never again…” Upon hearing that her face crashes into Adora’s neck once more. For the first time in so long, she feels safe, she doesn’t have to put up a front. Adora is the only one who can ever make her feel that way. She feels herself start to drift, but doesn’t fight it. She’s so safe and warm in Adora’s embrace.

She’s so warm, like she’s never felt before. It's almost like she’s lying beside a campfire with two strong arms around her, pulling her closer. Her head feels so fuzzy, so safe, so… red. There's no other way to put it. She slowly opens her eyes, greeted by the ceiling as usual , but what she feels is what startles her. There’s an arm wrapped around her. She already knows, but can’t get her head to turn. “Adora?” she questions softly. The body next to her shuffles closer and she feels lips pressing against her cheek.

“Morning, beautiful.” It’s her, she could never forget that voice. After a tense pause, Catra slowly turns to her side, and tries to contain her shock, seeing Adora laying there, blanket draped over her waist like a fucking Renaissance painting. She tries to keep her eyes up and maintain eye contact but that's just as difficult as not looking at the two large distractions in front of her. Adora looks at her as if thinking, “Is something wrong?” her eyes were sparkling concern and… something else. Adora swipes a strand of long blond hair out of her face. Wait… that's not right. She blinks and Adora looks different, shorter messier hair, slight subtleties of age in her skin that weren’t there a moment ago. “Catra?” Adora

questions, lightly squeezing her with the hand resting on her waist.

"I'm fine." she blurts out, stunned. She doesn't know what's going on right now.

"I told you not to drink so much last night, it may have been my birthday but that doesn't mean you have to get crazy. Want me to go make you a Classic?"

"No, no, I'm not hungover. I'm good… just a little disoriented."

"Well, I'm gonna get up and make one for myself." Adora rolls over and sits up, the sheets falling away to reveal her bare figure. Catra looks away, feeling her face flush. She hears shuffling as Adora gets up, and in her peripheral vision she sees her stepping into some shorts. She exhales, hearing Adora exit the bedroom, going to the kitchen. Now she can focus on trying to figure out what is happening. They were drinking at Adora's birthday party? That can't be right. They were… in bed together. Like it was nothing, like they usually do this— did they do anything? Catra finally thinks to look at herself, realizing she has nothing on as well. Oh god. It's like a dream come true and also a nightmare because she doesn't remember anything. This all feels wrong. "Catra." Adora calls out, breaking her concentration.

"Adora?" Catra hesitantly calls out in return. Adora walks into view from the doorway, and Catra feels her face get warm. Adora opens her mouth but what comes out isn't right, it isn't her voice it's Catra's.

"HEY! Happy birthday, you noble asshole!"

***"**What did you say!?" Catra asks bewildered. Adora gives her a strange look before her lips part once more.*

"I've been practicing living with regret for a while now, if you even care or ever wondered."

Catra feels the whole room shake violently. Just when she thinks the whole apartment will collapse, her eyes shoot open. She pants, staring at her ceiling. She feels slick with sweat. Taking another deep breath she remembers what was happening and quickly looks to her side. Her bedroom door is only cracked open. She rips her sheets off and she's fully clothed, jeans and all. Then she hears it, coming from the direction of her door.

"I'm sure you're great at that, you'd have to be. But anyway I would appreciate it if you stop astral projecting to me or whatever super powers your pure heart gives you!"

Catra stumbles out of bed, panicking and nearly falling over. She slams into her door and it swings open, and she's greeted by an incredibly shocked Adora sitting on her couch, holding her phone.

"Don't listen to that, I was drunk." she suddenly feels very self conscious as Adora stares at her. They're both unmoving as the voicemail continues.

"Huh, I suppose astral projecting would have been pretty beneficial to know about a couple years ago. Anyway, good luck with your life!" It ends with a quiet *hicc* and a *beep*. Catra looks away from her.

"Apparitions and astral projections? Catra, you're not getting into anything… hard are you?" Adora asks, her eyes oozing with concern.

"What the fuck are you even doing here? Actually, don't answer, I need to make something and shower first."

"I already made you a Classic." Adora chirps, like no time has passed. Catra glares at her and then the glass on the counter.

"Bet you made it wrong." Catra scoffs, walking to the counter and grabbing the glass.

"Well… I haven't exactly been practicing hangover cures lately, but how could I forget our recipe?" Adora looks at her with a hint of softness. Catra grabs the glass and downs it in one go.

"*Blech*. You made it all right. Now you better not *leave* while I shower." Catra glares at Adora again.

"Waited this whole time while you slept didn't I?" Adora grins at her.

"Whatever." Catra grumbles going back into her room for her bathrobe, before heading to the bathroom. She closes the door behind her and leans against it, taking a deep breath. She walks over and starts running the shower. This is *not* happening, she thinks, trying to remember last night. Instead she's only able to think about her dream, a glimpse into what could have been. She feels the phantom sensation of Adora's lips pressing against her cheek, an arm draped around her waist. She shakes her head and starts to get undressed, her body shudders as the thought of Adora undressing her flashes across her mind. Stepping out of her clothes she quickly turns the cold water all the way, this has to be *fast*. The cold water crashes against her and she shivers. Just need to get clean and get out, hot water will not lead to a quick shower, not while she's like this. She closes her eyes, leans in to wash her face, and stays there for a long moment. It isn't working, she can still see her. She steps back letting the water hit her chest, rolling down her body. She takes another step back and bites her lip.

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She cracks the door and peeks through, not seeing the back of Adora's head at the couch anymore. She opens it further and sticks her head out fully, expecting to see Adora rooting through her cabinets for snacks, but sees no such thing. Her heart starts

beating faster. She pushes the door open, hurrying out of the bathroom, and surveying her whole apartment. She's alone, like always, *like she deserves*. Everything starts to sway around her, nausea washing over her. She clutches her stomach and collapses onto her knees, retching. Panting, her face is slick with sweat again. All she can do is stare at the mess in front of her and try not to fall over. She doesn't even notice the door opening, until she hears her name being cried out. Panicked foot steps follow accompanied by two large hands on her shoulders. She weakly lifts her head up to see blue eyes filled with concern, staring into her.

"You… I thought…" she whispers weakly.

"Catra, I'm so sorry, I stepped out to take a call, and I heard a thud. Are you okay?" Adoea asks her, and Catra can't help but grin slightly.

"Does this look okay to you, 'Dor?" Adora frowns, looking away for a second and then back at her. Catra feels a pang of guilt in her chest, "Help me up, okay?" Adora nods, helping her up, taking her to her room, and onto her bed. She looks up at Adora, wondering why this sweet *and beautiful* woman still cares about her at all. "I need to get dressed and maybe lay down for a bit and then I'll get out there to clean up." She barely finishes her sentence before Adora responds.

"Yeah, right, I'm cleaning it. You're staying here." Adora glances at her closet "Want me to grab you something to put on?"

"I can dress myself just fine." Catra grumbles. Needing help to her room was already a massive blow to what little ego she had left. She won't let herself be some charity case but… it's not so bad when it's Adora helping her. Adora shoots her a quick smile before clearing her throat.

"I'll, uh, go do that now." Adora leaves her bedroom and closes the door behind her. Catra can't help but chuckle. Once an awkward dork, always an awkward dork. Catra pushes herself up

off the bed, and grabs some comfy clothes to throw on. Maybe she should've let Adora help her get dressed… is it too late to change her mind? God, this is so pathetic. She feels a strange sensation before hearing something odd. *I'll never leave you, Catra… never again…* She looks around confused, that wasn't real, and that definitely wasn't from her dream so where—

"Do you have any soup?" Adora suddenly calls out. Soup? It's not like she vomited because of the flu. She pulls her clothes on quickly before opening her door to look out. Adora is crouched down, rooting through her cabinets.

"You know it's not like I have a cold." Catra leans against the door frame. Adora turns her head to look back at her.

"I'm still gonna make you soup. Soup heals everything. Soup is good food." Adora says, continuing to rummage around.

"What I have, soup can't heal, Adora." Catra says, catching herself gazing at Adora's back. She always wears tight shirts that make her muscles so noticeable. Had she been showing them off while she was away? Did people flirt with her? *Did she flirt with anyone?*

"Of course, I mean, you have to wean yourself off very carefully, and withdrawal hurts like hell, but soup is a spiritual healer too." Adora gets up from her crouched position and turns to look at Catra.

"That's true but I'm not talking about alcohol." Catra stares right into Adora's eyes.

"You're not? Then…" Adora cocks her head in that oblivious golden retriever way.

"Alcohol is the symptom not the cause." Her heart starts beating faster as she maintains eye contact with Adora.

"Catra… do you remember last night?" Adora's expression changes, like she's gauging her reaction.

”I remember the park, but obviously I don’t remember the part where I invited you to live with me.” Catra snarks, not that she’s *totally* against that idea.

“I'm not moving in, I mean… anyways. You don’t remember saying anything to me here, last night?”

“You cannot trust anything a drunk person says, Adora.” Catra chides, worrying what she may have said *or done*. Images flash in her mind before she remembers being fully clothed in the morning.

“It was… too emotional not to be true.” Adora replies softly, taking a few steps forward.

“Adora Gray, I do not give a damn what I said, you can’t—-“ Catra’s breath hitches, “You left…”

“Last night I promised you I would never do that again.” Adora says and Catra’s whole body clenches hearing that. She turns her back to Adora. She tries to steady her breathing.

“You can’t… you can’t say that.” she chokes out.

“I meant it, Catra. I *still* mean it. Why do you think I’m even back here?” She hears Adora take a few more steps. She feels like her heart is going to burst.

“You’ve got Glimmer, Bow, and everyone else waiting for you here…” Catra breathes out, hugging herself. She gasps, feeling Adora press against her back, arms wrapping around her.

“I’m here for *you*, Catra. Things won’t be the same, they shouldn’t be. I want it to be more, that is if you still…” Is she really awake right now? It has to be a dream, but she doesn’t care. She’s so sick of running, so done with denying herself. Adora hugs her closer and she just can’t stop it. Her face feels like it’s on fire, until cool beads start rolling down her face, soon becoming a downright stream. She hasn’t felt like this in so long, her sadness

washing away. She sobs, too emotional to worry about how ugly it sounds.

"Oh god, Catra, I'm sorry. I shouldn't have said that so suddenly, I'm putting too much on you after all this time away. I shouldn't be here right now, you're right." She says pulling away from her. Without a second thought Catra spins around and embraces Adora.

"I still love you, you stupid fuck! You just said you wouldn't leave…" Catra says, muffled by Adora's chest. It feels like all the pressure is leaving her body, she could melt away right now. All that pain, she might actually get to escape it. Adora hugs her back so tightly, squeezing out all of her sadness. She could get lost in this moment, being so close in Adora's arms, *so safe*. She can feel Adora's muscles, her arms, her back, everywhere. *Are there muscles everywhere?* She shakes her head in Adora's chest— she freezes, realizing what she just did. After a long moment she slowly looks up at Adora, who looks like she is holding back the biggest laugh. They both bust out laughing, tears in their eyes. She had forgotten what it was like, to be happy. Before she knows what she's doing she's on her tippy toes, moving her lips towards Adora's, but she halts herself. She remembers that night, fighting, kissing Adora, and running away. Just when she is going to pull away, Adora pushes forward. Their lips meet gently, so softly, like a dream— No, something far better, something real. It's incredibly brief but Catra could have sworn a lifetime passed during that moment. Catra has to fight every urge in her body not to follow Adora with her lips, as she pulls away. Adora is smiling at her warmly, before beginning to speak.

"I think we should probably start to unpack some of our ba—" Adora is cut off by a loud bang on the door, quickly followed by another.

"I know you're in there!" shouts a familiarly shrill voice.

"I guess you should get that?" Adora says almost questioningly, letting go of Catra. She doesn't want to let go but she can't stand

clinging to Adora without reciprocation. She lets go and slowly works her way to the door. Instantly when Catra starts to open the door, Glimmer starts.

“What did you do to Adora! She sounded weird on the phone…” Glimmer trails off when Catra opens the door all the way revealing Adora.

“Oh. OH! Wow. I didn't think you two would *reconcile* this fast, and frankly I don’t know how to feel about this.” Glimmer says, visibly shocked.

“What? Stop whatever you’re thinking!” Catra exclaims recognizing the assumption in Glimmer’s tone.

“Good god, here I was running over thinking I'd have to do emergency first aid on one or both of you, before possibly sending one of you to the hospital myself. Adora didn’t come back last night and then, she called today and the last thing she does is exclaim your name and hang up the phone.”

“Hi. Yes, I am present in the room, thank you.” Adora mumbles, before realizing the mistake of drawing her attention.

“You made Glimmer of all people think I abducted you? I’m not some crazy ex-girlfriend!" Catra scoffs, crossing her arms

“You’re mad at me now? I didn’t make her think anything! She does this on her own!” Adora exclaims.

“I’m not mad at you! I just didn’t realize you were going to Gone Girl me!” Catra complains. Adora’s mouth hangs open for a moment before she thinks of something to say.

“You’re exaggerating!” They stare at each other. She wants to climb this big blond moron like a tree, and show her what's what. Glimmer coughs, and Catra turns her attention back to the pink menace.

“Anyway, Sparkles, Adora’s fine, I’m fine, we’re both adults.” She glares at Glimmer, who frowns, exhaling heavily from her nose, likely holding in a swarm of choice words.

“Expect to hear from Bow.” Glimmer says as if it's a threat.

“Thank god, the better half.” Catra gives a toothy grin. She watches in satisfaction as Glimmer strains herself not to blow up.

“Goodbye, Adora, we’ll talk later. *Catra*.” Glimmer says through gritted teeth, before turning to leave. The second she turns around, Catra closes the door. She breathes a sigh of relief.

“Now that that's over…” Adora clears her throat and leans against the counter, “We should maybe talk about some of that stuff. Some of *our* stuff.”

“*You* want to talk about it, huh?” Catra walks towards Adora, stopping right in front of her.

“Is that so unbelievable?” Adora’s cheeks turn a light shade of pink as she looks down at Catra.

“You’re the one who left.” Catra jabs her finger at Adora.

“Catra, please—”

“Stop saying that! I’m not some pouty child that won’t eat their broccoli!” Catra storms over to the couch, like an adult, and sits down. She can hear those big feet thudding over, before Adora sits down next to her.

“Okay, fine. I left. You drowned yourself in alcohol. Which are we doing first?” Adora asks bluntly, and Catra whips her head around to face Adora.

“You leaving caused it— I mean…” she takes a deep breath, and continues calmly, “It started after you left, so start at the beginning?” Adora is staring at her, like she can see into her soul through her eyes.

“There’s something we’re still avoiding. Something that’s been the missing factor in all of this.” Adora says. Catra wants to look away but she can’t. This all hurts but… “Do you remember when we were kids and that girl was making fun of my forehead? You appeared out of nowhere and socked her in the nose and then said something about crushing her forehead into a two-head.” Catra fidgets with her hands, before nodding.

“I was standing up for a new friend. People think they can treat anyone like shit if they’ve got money.” Catra shrugs her shoulders. There’s nothing she hates more than those with everything making life worse for everyone else. Adora reaches out and puts a hand on Catra’s.

“Thats when I fell in love with you…”

“Adora…” Catra’s heart is beating fast, “We barely knew each other at that point.” What kind of idiot falls in love after a maladjusted display of violence?

“You clearly knew me well enough to get in a fight for me.” Adora responds with a smug little grin. “I don’t think many seven year olds punch other seven year olds over playground insults, unless they really have a good reason.”

“Yeah, well you didn’t see the kids I was around before then. Let’s just say that little bitch was lucky I only threatened to renovate her skull.” Adora snickers at that, before returning to a somber expression. They don’t talk about Catra’s early years very often, she never wanted to bring that into her new life with Adora. With Adora she can pretend it never happened, it was just a bad dream. “It’s still crazy, and you never said anything that whole time. Maybe we could have avoided all this…”

“I did say something. You walked away.” Adora responds in a firm yet caring manner.

“Before all that, Adora. I thought… I thought it was just me because… why would you see me like that.”

“Why wouldn’t I see you like that? I wanted to say something so many times but I was afraid… I didn’t want to ruin… us. Like, remember back in highschool, with Seahawk and all the fire?” Catra practically burst out laughing at that comparison.

“Adora. They’ve been fucking since highschool. I think that stuff is just a big game of cat and mouse to them, they get some thrill out of it. Plus, Mermista just hates labels, or whatever, she had to say no to being a girlfriend. If that had really ruined their relationship, why do you think they were always messing around together afterwards?” Adora stares at her like she just pulled a rabbit from a hat.

“I thought they just worked it out into a healthy friendship?!” Adora says bewildered.

“God, Adora, you are so oblivious sometimes.” And it's so damn *cute*. “But, seriously, Adora,” Catra looks at her hands as if she was going to count her fingers, "That's so many years to keep that bottled up.”

“Well when did you fall for me, then.” Adora huffs.

“*Pfft*, who says I fell for you?” Catra snickers, and Adora gives her a knowing look.

“Okay, okay. There were moments… where I started to realize my life wasn’t so miserable anymore with you in it. Then those moments turned into, uh… this is stupid, why are you making me say this?” Catra feels her face heating up and Adora gives her those big pleading puppy dog eyes again. “Ugh, I didn’t understand what I was feeling around you until we hit highschool… you and your damn sports… I was noticing muscles and things started to make more sense.” Catra looks away, fully blushing now. Adora gently squeezes her hand and she turns back to face her. She has a big smile and Catra just knows she’s going to say something stupid.

“You fell for my *muscles*?” she says muscles in that stupid way where you pronounce the “c” like a total dork. Adora grins and flexes her arms. “Bought a ticket to the gun show and couldn’t get enough?”

“I knew it would go to your head. It wasn’t just that *obviously*.” She had already been so madly in love with the kindest most thoughtful person ever but it took that little kick of hormones and muscles to figure it out.

“Those other things were…” Adora leans in.

“Fat chance, Princess. Your head is big enough already, maybe another time.” Adora gives her a pouty look before recognition crosses her face and her cheeks redden.

”So, uhm, anyways, that's also a long time keeping it to yourself, you know? And clearly you didn't have the same Seahawk worries as I did.” Adora points out.

“Actually we should skip ahead to my drinking, it’ll be less rough on both of us.” Catra quickly replies. She does not have the energy for mushy gushy embarrassing and heart wrenching feelings talk right now.

“That, uh, sounds like something we shouldn’t skip but, I, uh, guess one step at a time?” Adora smiles weakly.

“Really there isn't that much to this. I got plunged back into a cruel world after… after you left, so I had a couple rough nights, which turned into weeks, and then… here we are.”

“That seems like a, uh, large jump. Rough weeks to now. That's a lot of weeks.” Adora says it with nothing but concern on her face yet that doesn’t stop it from angering her. She doesn’t know why it just *does*.

“Okay, rough months then. Is that what you wanna hear?“ Catra growls.

”No… I just— what's the point of talking about this if we aren’t being honest.”

“Whatever.”

“Are you still working at—”

“Photography.” Catra interrupts, “No boss to yell at you for being sad or hungover or late when you make your own hours.”

“I see… clearly that's been going well?” Adora says with that concerned look again. She might be in a bad place, but she isn't some helpless child.

“Keeps the roof over my head and the booze flowing. Not as fantastical as I used to think it would be but, *eh*, life's like that. Far better than Bright Mart, though. There’s nothing more pathetic than *Kyle* trying to comfort you behind the fucking milk. It's a miracle that didn’t immediately turn me into an alcoholic. I felt miserable and thought I could turn that misery into passion or something, so I pursued photography, did some lowkey gigs. Word of mouth can be a hell of a thing when you need money and other people can’t afford fancy ass photographers with booked up schedules.”

“Oh! That's nice, so you’re like the neighborhood photographer!” Adora says cheerfully.

“Yeah, something like that.” Catra mumbles, rubbing her temple with her free hand. “Look, could we get some food or something?”

“Only if we’re getting pancakes!” Adora beams.

“Not pancakes.” Catra groans, “I need something real.”

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Catra stares at Adora as she practically unhinges her jaw, shoveling a pancake into her mouth.

“Doesn’t that hurt?”

“MmFfbgb!” Adora slurs, her mouth full.

“You’re a literal child, chew and swallow first.” Catra says, shaking her head. Some things never change. Adora swallows loudly.

“Why would eating hurt?” Adora asks, preparing to stab another pancake.

“It shouldn’t, assuming you stop to breathe. Seriously, I've seen dogs eat slower.” Catra laughs, thinking how Adora truly is just like a golden retriever.

“I. Love. Pancakes. It’s criminal to go to IHOP and not get pancakes, Catra.” Adora chides.

“You’ve clearly never had their biscuit sandwich then.” Catra scoffs. She grabs her sandwich and takes a big bite, giving an exaggerated hum of satisfaction. Adora’s eyes start bulging out and shimmering like a cartoon puppy.

“Yes, you can try some.” Catra sighs, holding out her plate. Adora grins and reaches over greedily. She quickly takes a bite that Catra would describe as too much and sets it back down. Adora throws her head back, sparking a memory that makes Catra blush. She looks down at her sandwich once again, only getting further distracted by how much is now missing from Adora’s *bite*. A shiver runs up her spine. She *cannot* be getting horny from a sandwich at IHOP! Luckily, she was saved by Adora’s sheer nerdiness.

I got a pocket, got pocket full of sunshine

“That’s not seriously still your ringtone?” Catra slaps her hand on the table laughing.

I got a love and I know that it’s all mine, oh, oh-oh

“What's wrong with it?”

“Nothing,” Catra stifles another laugh, “If you’re that kind of person.”

Adora’s eyes widened looking at her phone, before hesitantly raising it to her ear.

”Hey, Glimmer… No, I'm not at her apartment.” Adora winks at her.

“What do you mean you can hear the deceit in my voice? I'm literally at IHOP…” Adora grins, playing with her fork.

“Well… I never said she wasn’t with me. I said I wasn't at her apartment…” Adora looks around as if Glimmer may jump out from anywhere.

“No, she didn’t mention that…” Adora turns her attention back to Catra.

“Sounds fun! Am I invited?” She quickly stuffs some pancake in her mouth.

“Mh, great!” she says, clearing her throat and taking a sip of water. “If I have my way, yeah. It would be good for her.” Adora says, glancing out the window. Catra narrows her eyes at Adora.

“Okay, bye, Glimmer.” Adora ends the phone call and looks over to see Catra glaring at her.

“Glimmer said Scorpia is having a party tonight.” Adora raises an eyebrow at her.

“Ugh, I forgot. What's the occasion again?”

“Hmm, Glimmer didn’t say. Maybe it’s just a get together, you know how Scorpia is.” Adora chuckles.

“That’s for certain.” Catra sighs. Frankly, Scorpia’s too nice, certainly too nice to her. She keeps trying no matter how much Catra pushes her back. It’s like she has some radar and once she’s locked onto you, she’ll never stop trying to help you. “I think Scorpia may call for a wellness check if I don’t make an appearance. I’ve missed that last couple get togethers, which reminds me, did you have anything to do with Sparkles showing up yesterday?”

“Huh? No. Did Glimmer say something to you?”

“She came over with some bogus intervention excuse and started shit with me.”

“Intervention? Is it really that bad?”

“She was talking about how long it had been since you left, and low and behold I ran into you at the park that night. She must've been feeling me out for this party and you coming back.” Catra says ignoring Adora. “But anyways, you finish shoveling down your pancakes and I'll eat what's *left* of my sandwich.” Adora smiles at her guiltily, before resuming stuffing her face. Catra exhales, trying to make herself enjoy this moment of peace, but after being reminded of the party she feels a familiar itch in the back of her mind. She has avoided many of Scorpia’s little get-togethers after the first few turned into altercations, so she isn’t looking forward to this one.

“And the check, please.” Catra looks up to see Adora with a to-go box. “You zoned out so I ordered myself a sandwich to go.”

“Your appetite will never cease to amaze me. How you can maintain that is a mystery.”

“You mean, maintain my *physique*?” Adora starts to flex her arms, “With guns like these, you gotta give ‘em some TLC, otherwise they won't fire when you need ‘em to.” Catra tries not to stare, but fails miserably. She can imagine them sheening with sweat in the heat, as her muscles flex— she buries her face in her palms.

“Huh? You okay?” Adora asks softly.

“Let’s just go.” Catra says weakly. Does the “H” in IHOP stand for *horny*? Because she sure as fuck is.

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“I know I said we’d talk but if we’re going to that party tonight, I need to lay down and mentally prepare.” Catra stretches her back, and sits down on the couch.

“Oh yeah, me too, for sure.” Adora replies from behind her. Catra turns to look at Adora.

“*You* need to mentally prepare for a social event?” she asks, grinning.

“Yeah, it's been like, two years since I saw everyone, I’m gonna be so out of the loop and what if everyone has all these inside jokes and they all get along so much better now than before and I’m the odd one out and what if they didn’t even miss me what if they get along better without me what if—” Catra is off the couch putting a hand on Adora’s shoulder.

“Adora, breathe. Slow… In and out. Do you hear yourself? Everyone loves you, it’s actually impossible not to.”

”I guess…” Adora murmurs.

“I know so. Hang in there, I’ll be right beside you, and hey, they actually miss *you*. Watch out for Mermista though, we had a small disagreement the last time I saw everybody.”

“A small disagreement?” Adora raises an eyebrow at her.

“Words were exchanged.” Catra shrugs.

“What kind of words?”

“A few bitches, maybe a skank or two.”

“You called Mermista a skank?” Adora laughs, her nose scrunching. God, that laugh. How many times has she wished to hear it again?

“Why do you assume I said it? She started it anyway.”

“You, uh, have some tendencies…” Adora points out. Catra frowns at that, subsequently noticing a splash of panic on Adora’s face.

“Tendencies that I have improved on! I bite my tongue, usually, and, one way or another, those emotions work their way into… artistic passion.”

“Can that kind of emotion be funneled into photography? Like painting or writing I understand how, but photography?”

“It depends how bad I’m feeling, but I find a way.”

“Maybe you could… show me how you do all that sometime?” Adora gives her a hopeful look.

“You want to watch me bottle up my rage into metaphorical rolls of film?” Catra questions.

“When you make it sound that badass, definitely!” Adora says with a big grin plastered on her face. Catra chuckles, and smiles back at her.

“Well, I suppose you could tag along.”

“Yay! You know… it could be fun to maybe… bring your camera tonight.”

“I don’t think that's a great idea, ‘Dor, and I don’t want to get roped into being the *party photographer* y’know.“

“Oh, of course. I just thought it could be a fun little thing. Capture some memories…” Adora looks down at her feet.

“Ah, jeeze, don’t look so heartbroken. Fine, but I’m only taking photos of you, maybe Bow too.” Catra says giving in.

“Yay!” Adora celebrates, before her face turns serious, “But seriously if you don’t want to, I don’t want to pressure you.”

“Now you’re trying to dissuade me? Make up your mind.”

“I just don’t want you to be uncomfortable.”

“This party is going to be plenty uncomfortable for me already, why not try to *capture some memories*?” Catra raises an eyebrow at Adora, who opens her mouth about to say something stupid again, but Catra doesn’t let her. “I’m going to the party with my camera, Adora.”

“Okay… Speaking of going, I forgot, my, uh, all my stuff is at Glimmer's. She probably wants to talk or shout at me too, maybe I should… go? I mean, uh, I don’t want to crowd you before the party and everything, and I’ll have to change and shower sometime… About what we said, I’ll be ba—”

“Just go, Adora. You don't have to assure me you aren’t ditching me forever when you leave to get clothes.” Her brow furrows slightly. ”But thanks anyways.” She whispers.

“Okay, uhm, Glimmer might hold me hostage, so I’ll see you… at the party?” Adora says, still harboring uncertainty in her eyes.

“Adora.” Catra steps closer, reaching out for her hand, and holding it in both of hers. She looks down at Adora’s hand, running a finger across her knuckles. She turns her gaze back to meet Adora’s, while gently squeezing her hand. Adora’s face grows redder, as her eyes dart around the room. Closing her eyes she raises Adora’s hand up and presses a knuckle against her lips, breathing in slowly. After a moment she lowers their hands and opens her eyes. “I’ll see you at the party.” As Catra lets go and pulls her hands away, Adora grabs ahold of her hand, raising it up. Catra can see something behind those sparkling blue eyes, but she doesn’t know what. Adora leans down and presses a kiss against the back of her hand, sending a tingle up Catra’s arm, which quickly travels through her body, stopping in her stomach.

“You can't just… copy me.” Catra breathes. Adora raises her head with a grin.

“You know, they say imitation is the sincerest form of flattery.”

“That mediocrity can pay to greatness, Adora.”

“What? That’s kinda mean…”

”That's the whole quote.” Catra says. Adora looks at her as if she dropped a groundbreaking revelation and it makes Catra *giggle*. She fucking giggled.

“Get out of here, you stink.” She playfully jabs Adora. They both walk over to the front door and Catra opens it.

“Okay, uhm, bye. I’ll see you later.” Adora awkwardly stands just outside the door.

“Bye, Adora.” Catra grins at her, before Adora’s face gets nice and pink before she finally runs off. Catra closes the door behind her, and realizes she’s still smiling.

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Chapter End Notes

Angst and Fluff and ;3
Monday the sixth marks the three month anniversary of me starting this fic! I had originally planned to wait until then to start posting but I got too excited.
I love feedback btw :)

Chapter 3: The Party / At The End Of The Night, I Am Walking Home

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra swipes a strand of hair from her face, the warm night air blowing past, her ponytail swaying. She doesn't normally put her hair up, but it's a party, and she hasn't exactly looked great recently. Not that she's trying to look good for anyone. She looks down at herself, a dark red long sleeve shirt with a *respectfully sized* opening at the chest and dark jeans, that no one else would realize are her favorite. She's fucked. This is bad. *She's trying*. Catra fidgets with the camera strapped around her neck to distract herself, rolling her thumb along a dial. She closes her eyes and breathes in, she's been here before since then, but now knowing Adora will be there too, it's all flooding back. Her legs begin to shake, feeling helpless— No, hopeless. Two years ago, everything fell apart here, and there's no point in thinking it could ever be put back together. *Why are you here? She can't possibly love you.*

"Catra." a voice calls out, shaking her from her trance. She turns to see Adora approaching, Bow and Glimmer trailing just behind her. Seeing Adora is like a smack in the face. She's wearing incredibly dorky cargo shorts, but then she has a white, sleeveless compression shirt on. It's hugging her in all the right places, while leaving her muscular arms free to be ogled. Not that Catra is staring or anything, *she's mentally drooling instead*. "I tried to dig out something decent, I don't look stupid do I?"

"No… Not at all." Catra breathes as Adora reaches her. "But one of us has to take their hair down." Catra notices Adora's familiar, albeit shorter, ponytail.

"Oh! I'll—"

”Nah, I’ll do it. I prefer having my hair down anyways.” And you don't seem like you’re desperately trying to look good for Adora with it down, Catra thinks as she lets her hair down, pocketing the hairband.

“Well, thanks then!” Adora grins, rubbing the back of her neck, and Catra thinks she notices something on Adora’s arm.

“Let me see your arm.” She grabs ahold of Adora’s right arm, turning it to see near her shoulder. She has a tattoo of a chain link fence with a singular sunflower peering out from behind it.

“How… How did I not notice this?” Catra asks, her mind racing.

“Uh, I think I've had a sleeve covering it until now. You don’t, um, hate it do you?” Adora asks meekly.

“Hate it? Why would I hate it? Why would you care what I think?” Catra looks up at Adora

“Of course I care, why would you say that? Especially since it’s…”

“Ahem.” Catra lets go of Adora’s arm and finds Glimmer staring at her. “Hi, Catra, it's so great to see you again.”

“It really is, I’m glad you came!” Bow adds cheerfully.

“It's great to see you too, Bow. How are you?” Catra stifles a laugh at Glimmer's incredulous expression.

“I’m doing well. Glimmer and I have been so excited for everyone to be together again!” Bow is practically vibrating with happy energy.

“You and Adora seem to be getting along well.” Glimmer remarks.

“Is that against the law?” Catra fires back.

“Just making an observation.”

“Are you gonna keep observing me or are we going inside?” Catra scoffs.Glimmer walks past them, Bow following after, giving an apologetic look.

“Are you ready, Princess?” Catra says looking back to Adora

“What?” Adora shakes her head like a cartoon character.

“I said, are you ready?”

“Uh, yeah, sorry.” Adora mumbles. Catra takes a step forward before turning back to Adora and holding out her hand.

“Don’t apologize, come with me already.” Catra feels her face heat up, and it only worsens as Adora takes her hand. They make their way into the building and to Scorpia’s apartment, and stand outside the door.

“You know we don’t have to—” Adora starts, but Catra cuts her off.

“You keep asking if I want to do this, but what do *you* want, Adora.”

“I… know this is a lot, that's all…”

“A lot for me or you, Adora? It's okay to not be fine. Say the word and we’ll both leave. We can stop by Bright Mart to get some oreos or something, maybe we’ll run into Kyle and you two could talk about nerd stuff. Maybe… we could see if they still grow there…”

“No… I… It’s okay, really, I’m just nervous, but, uh, maybe we can do that anyway after the party?”

“Sure.” Catra says, trying to hide the growing smile on her face. Catra knocks on the door, hearing rustling from inside, and the door swings open. Greeting them is a visibly shocked Scorpia, who quickly becomes ecstatic. Before Catra knows what's happening,

she’s trapped in a crushing embrace, causing her hand to slip from Adora’s

“Wildcat! You came!” Scorpia exclaims exuberantly.

“Scorpia— personal space, remember!” Catra gasps.

“Ohmygosh, Wildcat, I’m so sorry! I got so excited seeing you here!” Scorpia lets go of her, and seems to finally notice Adora. “Adora Grey, as I live and breathe! Glimmer said you might stop by, how the heck are ya?”

“Oh, I’m just glad to be back!” Adora says, smiling.

“We’re all glad to have ya back in town! Ah, jeeze, where are my manners, come on in you guys!“ Scorpia steps to the side holding the door open for them. As soon as Catra steps through the doorway, it’s like she entered a whole other world, raucous laughter and music filling the apartment.

Get no way with it, I get no way without

Losin' my head

No one even noticed, it'll be a mystery

Soon I'll be forgotten, now back to how I used to be

“Fair warning you guys, I thought it would be fun to have a punch bowl, but Seahawk definitely spiked it.” Scorpia sighs.

“Have you no hunger for adventure?” Seahawk shouts from somewhere out of sight.

“Wont stop me.” Catra shrugs. Adora gives her a look of concern and Catra huffs. Scorpia looks back and forth between them trying to read the situation.

“Well, uh, we’re all just hanging out right now, it turns out not everyone is as excited about board games as I was hoping.” Scorpia guides them to the kitchen, past the living room where Mermista is laying on the couch.

“Bored is literally in the name.” Mermista groans. “Look who it is.” She says sitting up.

“Mermista, it's great to see you again. How are you?” Adora asks.

“Oh, I'm just great, Adora. You know things have been *interesting* with you away.”

“Really? You’ll have to fill me in after I finish saying Hi to everyone.” Adora gives a big smile, which Catra knows is even faker than Mermista’s tits. She puts a hand on Catra’s shoulder guiding her away from Mermista and towards everyone else. Scorpia, Glimmer, and Perfuma are sitting at a table with snacks and *the punch bowl*. Surprisingly Glimmer seems to be looking at her with sympathy, *as if she asked for it though.*

“Oh my it really is so delightful to see you again, Adora, how we’ve all missed you! And Catra! It's always a blessing to have you! It is such a shame Entrapta couldn't make it tonight, she would have loved to see you both!” Perfuma says gleefully.

“Hey, ‘Fuma.” Catra tries to act unaffected by her words.

“Perfuma! I thought about you all the time, you wouldn’t believe what plants can manage to grow in the desert!” Adora exclaims. She thought about Perfuma *all the time*? Catra thinks, trying to fight against the twinges of jealousy she's feeling.

“Oh, my, you’ll have to tell me all about them!” Perfuma says smiling, as Scorpia sidles up behind her. Catra glances between them, and calms herself. From the big smile on Scorpia’s face, she must have finally asked out Perfuma, and gotten a good response.

“Careful, don't get too close with Adora back in town *somebody* might scratch you for it.” Mermista scoffs. Catra whips her head to glare at Mermista, who promptly sticks out her tongue.

“Ignore Mermista, she and Seahawk are fighting about something again, so she’s in a bad mood.” Glimmer chimes in.

“Ugh, just tell everyone why don't you?” Mermista groans from behind them.

“Wait, yeah, where is Seahawk? We heard him shouting as we came in.” Adora looks around.

“I put him in time-out for spiking the punch.” Scorpia replies.

“They could not handle my adventurous spirit, so they imprisoned me!” Seahawk’s voice bounces into the kitchen.

“I’ll have to thank him later, I need some of that.” Catra begins to prepare herself a cup, and Adora puts a hand on her shoulder, leaning in to whisper.

“Catra, are you sure that's a good idea?”

“Yes, I am, Adora.” Catra whispers back.

“I just think—” Catra grabs Adora’s hand and leads her away from everyone.

“Uh oh, trouble in paradise.” Mermista says loud enough for them to hear before they’re out of earshot.

”You do understand that I cannot just quit drinking, Adora? I’m already feeling it. I’m all for recovery and shit, but I need to live long enough to do that. You'd think Miss ‘withdrawal is hell’ would know that, what's a girl like you know about withdrawal, Adora?”

“I…” Adora rubs her arm and looks down. She doesn’t continue.

“Adora?”

“I saw a lot of things….” her voice shakes, “People at their lowest, and I mean *low*, Catra.”

“I’m sorry… I didn’t realize…”

“It’s alright, let’s just… try to have some fun? This is a party right?” Adora cracks a little smile.

“Okay.” Catra gazes at her before turning back to everyone else and exclaiming, “Unleash Seahawk!“

“Free me for I shall bring life to this party!” Seahawk shouts in return.

“Bow is watching him, I’ll go get them.” Glimmer says before walking off.

“Scorps turn it up!” Catra takes a big swig of punch before setting it down, along with her camera. She grabs Adora’s hands leading her to a nice open space in front of the couch Mermista is currently groaning from.

“There you are my love! Let us dance!” Seahawk bounds over to the couch.

“Maybe later. If you’re quiet you can sit with me.” Mermista grumbles in return.

“I can do much more than that my love!” Seahawk crashes onto the couch, wrapping an arm around Mermista.

“May I have this dance?” Adora asks

“Why do you think I pulled you over here?”

Buckle up for a wild ride

Keep your legs and your hands inside

Adora hesitantly puts her hands on Catra's waist and it makes her snicker, Adora never could dance.

"Just don't start slow dancing, okay?" Catra laughs.

She's the one that'll make you scream

All right, all right all right

"I don't know how to do this!"

"I know you don't, but I guess I don't either. At least I have natural rhythm, though." Catra interrupts whatever Adora thinks is dancing, to pull her closer.

Hey, when the groove takes hold

She parties, she parties

Catra sways her hips, while slowly dragging her hands from Adora shoulders, all the way down her arms, and pulls her hands from her waist to hold them. She pushes Adora away before pulling her back in. They go back and forth like that a few more times before Catra dips Adora.

Later on when the night unfolds

She parties, she parties

Catra’s hand glides up Adora’s arm and past her shoulder, until it's comfortably planted in her hair. She gently puts pressure on Adora's head, so that their foreheads rest against each other. Adora’s big blue sleepy eyes are staring into her, as her warm breath glides across Catra’s face. She doesn’t think, it all just happens on instincts. Her hand grips Adora’s hair firmly, and pushes their faces together. Adora grabs hold of her tighter as their lips meet. It's like a little game, one where Catra tries to ruin Adora. She brings her other hand to Adora’s cheek, slowly dragging her nails down Adora’s neck, drawing out a whimper that Catra quickly devours. With a final firm grab of Adora’s hair, she presses a deep kiss, before parting their bodies. Adora looks and sounds like she just ran a marathon with how pink her face has grown and heavy she is breathing. Catra stares at her basking in her work, *now this is art*.

She can light up the room, I'm told

She parties, she parties

She parties

“Ugh, I’m gonna vomit.” Mermista groans.

“Why must you say such things, Mermista my dearest? Is love not the most beautiful of things?”

“They basically fucked in front of us.”

“The beauty of love, my dear, the beauty of love!”

“I thought you two were fighting?” Catra turns to them and raises an eyebrow at the fact Seahawk is almost entirely sitting in Mermista’s lap now.

“Whatever.” Mermista grumbles. Catra goes back to finish her drink, and quickly whips around with her camera pointed at Adora.

“Catra, no, not now!” Adora exclaims, clearly aware of how pink and *messy* she looks. She darts towards Catra, hand outstretched, but she isn't fast enough. **CLICK-CLICK.** Catra ducks under Adora’s grapple.

“Too late, Princess, these are gold!” Catra laughs. As Adora is still trying to grab the camera, Catra admires her photography skills. Adora’s hand was covering a fourth of the lens, but her bright pink face and disheveled hair was in full view, *as well as her new lipstick.*

“Fine, fine. I need some punch.” Adora relents and approaches *the punch bowl*, fixing herself a drink. She takes a sip and coughs.

“Ugh, what did you spike this with, Seahawk?”

“Rum! What else would an adventurer drink!”

“Adora isn't cut out to be a pirate, I'm afraid. She only likes drinks if they’re bubbly or in a copper mug.” Catra teases.

“It accentuates the flavor!” Adora says, trying to defend herself.

“No, it doesn’t.” Catra stifles a laugh.

“What’s so funny?” Adora sits down and takes another small sip. Glimmer looks at Adora then Catra.

“Are you gonna tell her?”

“Tell me what?” Adora looks back and forth between them.

“That Catra is probably getting off on the fact, you have her lipstick smeared all over your face.”

“Way to ruin my fun, Sparkles.” Catra says disappointed.

“My pleasure.” Glimmer says smiling as Adora hastily gets up, making a beeline for the bathroom. Catra quickly follows behind her, so closely that Adora didn’t have a chance to begin closing the door before she was in with her. Instead of fighting her Adora turns to assess the *damages* in the mirror. Catra takes the opportunity to *lock* the door behind her.

“I can’t believe you were going to let me walk around like this in front of everyone.”

”Oh, so, being in front of everyone is the problem? You know I could…” Catra slinks closer, bringing her mouth a hair’s width away from Adora’s ear to whisper, “Put some marks where no one will see…” Adora gasps, and Catra pulls away, half expecting steam to come from Adora’s ears with how red her face is. “Well, Princess, what do you want—” In an instant, Adora pins her against the door, towering over her.

“Do you even understand how badly I’ve wanted this… wanted you? Adora's voice oozes with hunger. “We both share in blame for how things turned out, but, fuck, if that kiss didn’t wake something in me, only to lose any chance for more. Until now, and I won’t just let you walk away from my life again, so what do *you* want? Do you wanna touch me?” Catra’s hand traces along Adora’s abs slowly.

“I want… to rip this fucking shirt off your chest, so I can stuff it in your mouth, and teach you what you’ve been missing.” Catra feels her heart thump as Adora’s thigh finds its home between her legs, and she can't help but lean into it.

“You aren’t in a position to teach me anything. Get taught, maybe, but you never were one to listen without *strong* reinforcement.” Adora says firmly. Where did this come from? Adora was never this confident before… and it’s making her feel weak, like she could just give in and let Adora *have* her. She can’t let it be that easy, though.

“You’re not going to teach me anything in Scorpia’s bathroom while our friends are a few seconds away.”

“Oh, I’m not?“ Suddenly there’s a strong hand around her throat, and ravenous lips crashing into hers. She feels Adora’s other hand grabbing at her waist possessively. As they part for air, Adora bites onto Catra’s lower lip, tugging for a moment before releasing her.

“Is that all you got, Princess?” Catra breathes, leaning in only to get pushed back against the door with a thump.

“I’m just getting started.” She buries her face in Catra’s neck working her way down, covering it in greedy kisses. Catra tries to hold back but little whimpers keep escaping. She’s the one who started this, so she’s not supposed to be *losing*. She has to make a move.

“Adora~” Catra quietly moans into her ear, as she brings her hands around Adora’s back, up to her shoulders, before clawing them down.

“Fuck!” Adora groans.

“Too bad this shirt was in the way…”

“You need—”

“I need what, Princess?” Catra’s lips curl into a grin. Just as Adora’s lips part, there is a bang on the door, and they both freeze. Glimmer's voice shortly follows.

“Scorpia couldn’t bring herself to say it in this exact way, but she wanted me to say: Do not fuck in her bathroom, and especially don’t when we are all within earshot of your utter sluttery. I swear to god we can hear you two *dripping* over the music.” They both finally exhale, as they hear Glimmer’s footsteps grow distant.

“And I thought I couldn’t get any more rock bottom.”

“It's not… that bad…” Adora gives a weak smile, her lips still smeared red.

“Adora, that was pretty fucking bad. What are we, two horny teens sneaking off and getting caught with your hands in my pants?”

“Okay, that does sound pretty bad, I will admit, but, uh, we’re all friends, surely, uhm, Seahawk and Mermista have done something of an equal level.”

“They pretty much keep it in their pants around us, but I’ll never forget when I ran into them at the mall.” Catra sticks her tongue out like she’s going to vomit, “Otherwise, Seahawk party fouls are definitely not equivalent to *this*.” Catra gestures between them.

“Great… Well we should probably get out there and damage control.”

“No, first you wash your face. You look like a messy wine mom right now.”

“You wish you could see me being a wine mom.” Adora says between splashes of water on her face.

“Just clean your damn face!” Catra playfully punches Adora’s shoulder. Once Adora no longer looks like she’s destroyed on red wine, Catra musters her courage and best bitch face, before opening the bathroom door. As they rejoin the party everything goes awkwardly quiet. Adora is the one to finally break the silence.

“We made it weird, didn't we?”

”No…” both Bow and Scorpia quickly reply.

“Pretty much.” Mermista adds bluntly.

“I for one think your love is magnificent! You should never be ashamed of passion!” Seahawk declares.

“I knew I shouldn't have come here.”

“Wildcat, don't say that! You just got here.” Scorpia says sadly.

“And made it *weird* immediately.” Catra replies.

“Don’t listen to Mermista, she’s just, uh…”

“You and Bow are terrible liars, and Sparkles hides her contempt about as well as I do. I know when I’m no longer wanted, I’ll see myself out.” She starts walking towards the door, and Adora chases after her.

“Hey! We don’t have to leave… I’m sure we’ll all be laughing about it in an hour.”

“*We* aren’t leaving. I am. They all love you, I’m sure you’re the real reason they’re even having this party.”

“I’m not letting you leave on your own. I could power through the awkwardness if you stayed, but if you’re going, then I’m going, okay?”

“You’re a grown woman, I can’t stop you.”

“I’ll show you just how much I’ve grown…” Adora whispers in Catra’s ear, before calling out to everyone else, “Sorry, guys, we’re gonna head out! It was great seeing you all. We can chat another time!” Before anyone could respond Catra is already out the door, and Adora hastily follows after her. She doesn’t know if she rushed out to escape their friends or Adora because she might just climb on top of her after what she said.

“Hey! Catra, slow down.” Catra stops moving all together. “You didn’t have to stop.” Adora says, catching up with her. “Is something wrong?”

“What are we doing Adora?”

“What do you mean?”

“I mean, are we really doing this? Is this smart? We started tearing each other's clothes off and made a scene, and it's been what, 48 hours?” Catra says, bringing her gaze to the floor.

“I’ve never known what’s smart or not, but I’m pretty good at knowing what’s right. With how much history we have together, I can’t imagine my life without you in it. I learned that much while I was away. We can slow things down… It’s probably for the best.”

“The worst part is, I don't know if I can take more waiting, but I also don’t want to ruin this chance by acting as if we’ve been a thing for the past two years.” Catra sighs, looking up to see Adora giving her a half-lidded smile.

“In that case, Catra Herrera, will you be my girlfriend?” Adora holds out her hand.

“Adora Grey, nothing would make me happier.” She takes hold of Adora’s hand, savoring the warmth *and sweatiness*.

“What do you say, tonight we take a trip down memory lane too?"

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Chapter End Notes

Drama! Smut! SEAHAWK! Who’s ready for the penultimate chapter? So fast I know, but trust me it’ll be a fun *ride* ;)

Chapter 4: The Part Where They ~~Fuck~~ Go To Bright Mart And Then Fuck / Everyone Gather 'Round

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

BRRNG! The automatic doors slide open, and fluorescent lights bleed out onto the concrete. It doesn't feel completely real, she has managed to almost completely avoid going here for two years. Somehow it seems exactly the same, she can even hear the same supermarket music playing. It's a nice tune on its own, but it's basically the only music they play, so it turns into a form of torture if you work there. Any song played ad nauseum will drive you insane, and she still isn't sure if it's on purpose by management to break your spirit or just incompetence. Adora's hand on her shoulder, brings her back to reality.

"What's up? Want me to carry you past the threshold?"

"I don't remember getting hitched, unless there was something really strong in that punch."

"But really…"

"It's nothing. Just memories."

"Yeah, we sure had a lot of… times here."

"Yeah…"

"Well, after you, M'Lady." Adora bows, holding out an arm.

"I forgot how embarrassing you are to be around in public." Catra snickers, walking into Bright Mart. The fluorescent lights are so much worse once you're inside. "Let's just get our stuff and get out."

“You mean you don’t wanna hang around and look for Sloane?” Adora laughs.

“You mean, *Ms. Weaver*,” Catra says mockingly, “No, I do not want to see Sloane the Groan.”

“Then let's get those Oreos!” Adora exclaims jumping around like a giddy kid. They start to roam through Bright Mart, down the aisles, and find themselves staring at dozens of different Oreos.

“Why… Why are there so many?” Adora says, shocked.

“Capitalism, Adora. Maybe you forgot about it. There are a lot more than I remember though, like what is a Chocolate Peanut Butter Pie?”

“S’mores? I can feel my heart stopping just looking at them.”

“Shit, that sounds good.” Catra bends down to look at a box.

“You would say that.” Adora teases. Catra turns and sticks her tongue out at her..

“Shut up, you’d probably eat the Carrot Cake ones.”

“That’s… probably not true... Where are they?” Adora looks around. Catra snickers and points.

“Oh, god, Pumpkin Spice, I’m gonna hurl, Adora.” Catra groans.

“No, you’re gonna hurl, when you see Swedish Fish.” Adora waves a box of Swedish Fish Oreos in Catra’s face.

“Get that out of my face!” Catra swats at Adora, who eventually relents while sporting a dopey grin. “At least there aren't any pickle flavored ones…”

“But there are HOT CHICKEN WING OREOS!” Adora exclaims, pointing at said Oreos.

“Now I’m actually going to be sick.” Catra grabs a pack of S’mores Oreos. “We’re leaving once we get some refreshments, I really don’t wanna be hanging around here.” She leads Adora through the aisles until stopping and standing befuddled before shelves of Kombucha.

“Where the hell’s the booze? Before you say anything, Adora, this is strictly so I don’t *die*, and maybe a little for fun tonight.”

“I get it, I get it, but I will forcibly swaddle you if you get too rowdy, so keep that in mind.”

“Pfft, you wish you could immobilize me.”

”Is that a challenge?” Adora steps closer to her. Suddenly a squeaky voice interrupts them before they can have a second PDA event in the same night.

“Adora? Catra?” They both turn to see a skinny, blond boy in a green Bright Mart shirt looking at them.

“Kyle? It's been so long!” Adora cheerfully exclaims.

“Yup… it’s me. When did you get back?”

“The other night.” Adora puts an arm around Catra’s shoulder.

“Oh, uh, so soon, I thought since…” His eyes quickly dart to Catra and return to Adora, “I just thought you had been back longer, and I wasn't going to blame you for not running back here to see us..”

“Oh man, is the gang still working here?” Adora looks around.

“Actually… Lonnie is the acting manager, so—”

“No more Sloane the Moan!” Catra cackles.

“Right, you wouldn’t know either, since you've never come by.”

“The prices here suck.”

“Well, I’ve, uh, gotta go. I think Rogelio is stocking, so you might bump into him, and uh, if you wanna hang out a bit, I’m sure Lonnie would like to have a little chat or something.” Kyle scurries away

“Shit, I wanted to ask him what happened to the booze.”

“What was that?” Adora says with that all too familiar look of concern.

“That was Kyle.” Catra says, examining a bottle of kombucha.

“I mean the even-more-awkward-than-usual exit.”

“Maybe Kyle has gotten more awkward with time.” Catra shrugs. Adora makes eye contact, giving her an insistent look.

“Lonnie is very good at getting on my nerves, and one day I may have threatened to put her face in the deli slicer.” Catra says as nonchalantly as possible.

“CATRA!” Adora exclaims, completely caught off guard.

“She had been making so many digs at me about you. She knew what I was going through… I quit after that. “

“I forgot you two always did have tension.”

“Not sure what I ever did to her, though.”

“But, wait, you said it was about me?”

“I don’t wanna talk about it, Adora.” Catra looks away.

“Maybe we should find her, and I can have a word or two…”

“No!” Catra turns and clutches onto Adora’s arm, “I’ll tell you but then we’re getting drinks and leaving, okay?” Adora takes a moment and then nods.

“It was just stuff about, like how she was surprised I hadn’t already bought a plane ticket to stalk you, or did I finally try coming onto you and drive you away…” Catra slowly lets go of Adora’s arm, whose face becomes stern.

“You’re right we should get some drinks and go.” Adora grabs a hold of Catra’s hand. They have to wander for a bit before finally finding the alcohol.

“Look Adora, they have Whiteclaws, perfect for you.”

“I don't drink Whiteclaws.”

“Oh? I thought you loved claws?”

“Wh— What are you talking about? Grab some vodka, I’ll go get some good mix-ins.”

“Just don’t come back with Mtn Dew.” Catra laughs, looking at the drinks.

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Eventually Adora returns with cherry Fresca.

”What is *that*?”

“You said anything but Mtn Dew. Trust me.”

“We’re getting white-girl wasted huh?” Catra gives a mischievous grin.

“Don’t knock it til you try it.”

“God, you’re such a dork.”

***

As they approach check out, Catra studies the cashier, they seem oddly familiar, but it's likely since they're probably her replacement, working register and everything. Their nametag says Octavia. Well, something about *Octavia* is pissing her off.

"ID's." She says in a gruff voice. Adora hands over hers, and quickly gets it back, but Octavia seems to linger when Catra hands over her ID. Octavia glares at her, handing it back.

"What's your issue?" Catra glares back at her.

"Don't have one, do *you* want one?"

"This wouldn't be the first time I've had to beat someone in this store." Catra remarks.

"Gonna cut my face off?" Octavia growls.

"Now I remember, you're—" Catra blinks and sees a fist suddenly pulled back in her direction, but just as quickly as the fist was raised, there's a *crack*, and Octavia is flat on her ass, clutching her nose. "Lonnie's girlfriend…" Catra trails off, turning to see Adora shaking off her hand. "What the hell?" Catra exclaims, finally comprehending what just happened. Adora quickly bags their groceries and tosses a few bills down towards Octavia.

"Keep the change, you look like you could use it."

"What the hell?" Catra repeats.

"We should probably go." Adora grabs her hand rushing her out. Once Adora slows down, Catra smacks her upside the head.

"What the hell was that about?"

“I'm sorry this just all reminded me of when we were kids and I had to do what I didn't have the courage to do then. I have to…” Adora pulls her into a deep kiss and Catra loses herself in it. Partially because of the adrenaline flowing through her and partially because she wants this so badly after being denied at the party. She pushes closer against Adora, kissing her harder. Their lips part, both breathing heavily.

”We should get back to my apartment.” Catra breathes.

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Catra fumbles with the key as Adora is teasing her fingers along her waistband, occasionally dipping them in ever so slightly. She feels a familiar warmth spreading into her body. She finally gets the key in, unlocking the door, and nearly gets shoved in by Adora. As Catra is locking the door, Adora quickly puts their groceries on the counter before bearing down on her again. Her fingers slip under Catra’s waistband as they kiss, Adora once again pinning her against a door. This time one of Adora‘s hands trails around to Catra’s ass, before sinking into her jeans. She can’t help but gasp, feeling Adora’s massive hand on her, interrupting their kiss.

“Lets… go to my bed.” Catra manages to say. Without a word, Adora scoops her up into her arms and carries her. Catra wraps her arms around Adora, kissing her neck and giving it a little bite, before getting tossed onto her bed. Just as soon as she lands, Adora is already on her, hands grabbing hungrily. Adora’s breath is heavy against her ear as she whispers.

“When I saw you in that ponytail, I knew I needed to do this to you.” She grabs a hold of Catra’s hair in one hand, pulling back on it, so that her neck was completely vulnerable. Adora starts placing long kisses all over her neck, while her other hand

unbuttons Catra's jeans, slipping in. Catra let out a soft moan as she felt Adora's fingers pressing against her through the fabric of her panties. "You like it when I'm in control?" Adora quietly whispers into her ear.

"You fucking wish." She tries to push Adora onto her back, but only succeeds in getting her own hair pulled harder. Adora removes her hand from her pants and Catra lets out a whine of disappointment.

"Don't you think you should get undressed?" Adora whispers between kisses. She tries to nod the best she can, with Adora's grip on her hair. "Good." Adora coos, releasing her. She slowly gets up, standing with her back to Adora, she is not going to let Adora win this easily. Catra opens her closet and quickly grabs something, obscuring it from Adora's view. She moves to leave her bedroom, stopping in the doorway, to turn her head back. "Stay." she tells Adora, before making her way into the bathroom. She closes the door and quickly strips naked before putting something special on, and getting back into her clothes. She turns to the mirror, staring back at herself. For a long moment she doesn't move. Here she is, after all this time. She raises a hand to touch her cheek. It's real. Stirring from her trance she opens the bathroom door and returns to her bedroom. Adora is sitting at the edge of the bed looking at her curiously.

"I thought you'd come back in nothing but a bath robe."

"What else were you thinking about?" Catra asks, stepping forward and straddling Adora.

"How much I wish we hadn't been interrupted earlier, but maybe it's for the best, now that we're here together."

"Hmm, yeah I bet you were pretty disappointed to lose that moment of power, but here we are." Catra wraps her arms around Adora's neck and leans in to kiss her, but instead bites her lower lip, tugging before releasing it.

“Had to repay that, but don’t worry you’ll be getting a lot more. I’ve got so many years pent up inside me, Adora. *Now you’re mine*.” She buries her face into Adora’s neck, trailing kisses up and down, occasionally stopping to suck hard and nip at her. She continues doing so, until she can tell from Adora’s desperate noises, that anymore and Adora may just work up the confidence to fight back some more.

“Now, you can undress me.” Catra stands up, off Adora, cupping the side of her face and looking right into her eyes. Adora looks at her with a dazed smile until Catra removes her hand. Adora looks down at Catra’s waist, and reaches out to undo the button of her jeans. “Ah-ah-ah.” Catra tuts, “Start higher.” Adora stands up, carefully reaching down to the hem of Catra’s shirt, slowly raising it up. When she gets halfway catra raises her arms up, and Adora gasps, pulling the shirt off, revealing a lacy crimson bra.

“See something you like?” Catra teases.

“It's… a good color on you…”

“Wanna find out if it's matching?” Adora nods, dropping the shirt to the ground and slowly unzipping Catra’s jeans, similarly revealing lacy crimson. Adora gets one last surprise as she crouches, pulling down Catra’s jeans, suddenly face to face with garter straps hugging her thighs. Adora springs up.

“Why do you have these?” She asks in an almost accusatory voice.

“Why do I have lingerie?” Catra asks slightly taken aback

“Who else has seen these?”

“Oh!” Catra exclaims in a moment of realization, “You’re jealous! That's so cute on you.”

“I’m serious. A lot can happen in two years.”

“And if something did?”

“I’d fuck you so much better than they did.” Adora says, her lips inches away from Catra’s.

“Who says they fucked *me*?” Catra whispers.

“So there was someone!” Adora pulls away.

“Oh, Adora. I'm sure you had fun while you were away.” She trails her hand along Adora’s chest.

“There was a sweet girl I worked with. I…” Adoea starts to say, and Catra feels a pit forming in her stomach.

“I didn’t realize she was asking me out when she wanted to get coffee. When I did, I thought maybe it would be good for me, but at the end of the night, there was just a hole. It was like… I knew it could only ever be you…” Adora admits. Catra raises a hand to Adora’s cheek.

“It's only ever been you, Adora. These were on sale one day and I couldn't pass it up. Clearly I made the right choice. “

“But you said—”

“You assumed a lot, but… I wanted to know if there was ever anyone else for you.” The last part comes out in a whisper.

“You scared me… not that, uh, you weren't allowed to have had, uhm, relations while I was gone. We weren't, uh, together but I just got kinda…”

“Jealous?”

“No… maybe.”

“Save that jealousy for another time, ‘kay, Princess?

Catra reaches up to pull Adora's face into a kiss. Adora's hands come down to grip Catra’s ass. Catra starts moving Adora

backwards until she bumps into the bed and gives her a quick shove, breaking them apart and sitting Adora down again.

“Take that shirt off for me.” Catra commands, and Adora does so without pause.

“No surprise for me, huh? Still wearing the same grey sports bra? That's okay, you’ll be taking it off anyways.” She leans in to kiss Adora, whose hands find their home on Catra’s ass once again, fingers sinking in.

“Someone’s eager.” Catra coos, breaking away from their kiss. Adora mumbles something incomprehensible in response. “Now let's get rid of that bra and see what's underneath” Adora slowly pulls off her sports bra. Catra takes a deep breath trying to remain collected. She's into Adora’s eyes but can feel her gaze being tugged down, and then she gives in. “Oh, Dor, you’re so beautiful.” Adora’s face turns as red as Catra’s lingerie. She reaches out to gently cup Adora in one hand. “I’ve dreamt of this for so long…” She squeezes softly, and a small moan escapes Adora’s mouth “Are you cold?" Catra asks and they both share a small chuckle.

“No… not cold” Adora looks at her as if she were in a trance

“Then…” Catra feels a pulsing warmth, “Lie down.” Adora turns to look around the bed, before swinging her legs up and lying down. Catra sits at the edge and crawls towards Adora, lowering her head to Adora’s chest. Adora lets out a small whine as Catra's breath grazes along her nipple. Catra grins before taking it into her mouth. She sucks slowly savoring the taste of Adora, flicking softly with her tongue, until she feels Adora’s hand in her hair. She looks up, without ceasing her ministrations, and Adora looks back at her with such hunger, only fueling her fervor. Adora whines as Catra gently bites down, while running her nails along Adora’s sides. She lets go, raising her head to look up at the panting, blond mess in front of her. Catra hums, hand tracing along Adora’s waistband.

“Wonder what's under here?” She gives the button on Adora’s shorts a flick, “Should we find out?” Adora nods enthusiastically, and Catra swiftly unbuttons and unzips Adora’s shorts, sliding her hand in.

“Ooh… hah— wow…” Adora moans.

“Someone’s sensitive.” Catra remarks with a smile.

“It’s a lot different when… ohh… when it’s someone else…”

“Hmm, I bet. Guess you’re just gonna have to pay me back after this, huh?”

“Yeah…” Adora mutters. Catra moves her fingers up, rubbing in a small circle, making Adora gasp.

“Fuck…” Adora throws her head back. Catra moves her hand up and then under Adora’s underwear.

“Oh fuck, Catra…” Adora moans, as Catra rubs her, skin against skin, sharing warmth and slick love. She listens to Adora’s reactions, systematically finding all of her weak spots, so she can bring her right to the brink before slowing down. “You’re such a fucking tease.” Adora practically growls at her.

“Oh, I am? We can change that.” Catra ramps up her effort before slowly sinking a finger inside. Adora leans forward and grips the sheets. “Oh wow, Princess, you’re squeezing me so good.”

“Shut… up…” Ador grumbles. Catra grins before leaning down to once again fill her mouth, flicking her tongue along the sensitive bud, while pumping her finger in and out of Adora. Catra feels Adora pressing against her hand wordlessly asking for more, and she happily obliges, savoring every last whimper and moan. They continue like that until Adora cries out, clenching onto Catra’s finger. Catra lays next to Adora, pressing kisses against her cheek until she has caught her breath.

”I’m sorry…” Adora says softly.

“Why are you apologizing, dummy?”

“Because that wasn’t… It was so fast.”

“As if I would be disappointed after destroying you.” Catra grins.

“Shut up… I mean that's good. It really is so much different.”

“If you‘re really worried about my pleasure, I do have an idea.” Catra trails her fingers along Adora’s jaw.

“Uh, yeah. I’m game.”

“Pfft!” Catra laughs, “You’re such a dork.” Adora wiggles her eyebrows at her.

“Stay there.” Catra sits up and hops off the bed before pulling down her panties. She quickly climbs back onto the bed, and over Adora, straddling her waist. “Do you wanna put that mouth of yours to good use?”

“You’re just embarrassed by how much you love when I say dorky stuff.”

“Shut up.” Catra scoots further up, until she finds Adora’s face just in front of her, “Any last words?” Catra grins.

“Do you remember that night after work?” Catra’s eyes widen, her cheeks growing red, as she remembers the taste of cheap alcohol.

“Of course I do. I always thought you didn’t. You’re gonna remember tonight for sure though.” Catra lowers herself onto Adora’s face before she can speak. She slowly starts rocking her hips back and forth as she feels Adora’s tongue pressing against her. She looks down into Adora’s eyes. Big mistake. Now she can’t look away. Gazing into Adora’s eyes, while grinding on her face. “Mmm… You’re doing so good for me.” Catra coos, rocking back and forth, “Ooh… right there… Shit. You’re sure you haven’t done this before?” Adora simply looks back at her with a half lidded

stare. It’s too much. Too good. Her thighs squeeze around Adora slightly, feeling the pleasure wash over her until it was like she got completely swept away in an ocean of bliss. She moves off Adora, collapsing next to her. Adora rolls onto her side to face Catra. ”What’re you staring at?” she mumbles.

“You. What else?” Adora beams. Catra opens her mouth, but Adora continues, “It’s just, I can really feel it right now, our love. It’s in the air, it’s—”

“All over us and sticky.” Catra interrupts. Adora laughs, her nose snorting.

“Yeah but don't you feel it too?”

“I guess I know what you mean.” Catra whispers. Adora pulls her close into a hug, pressing their warm sweaty bodies together.

“You know, I don’t actually have a place to live right now. Staying at Glimmer’s is temporary…” Adora says, pulling away slightly.

“Adora, are you asking to move in with me?”

“Yes?” Adora looks at her hopefully.

She looks Adora in the eyes. After everything could she really be so lucky? In that moment she feels for the first time in so long, that things could be looking up. That life could be going her way for once. She has never meant anything more in her life than what she says next:

“Nothing would make me happier.”

Chapter End Notes

Gasp! Oreos, violence, and finally getting to fuck! What more could you ask for?
This is it folks, a short epilogue is next. What do you think our girls are gonna be up to in the future? I really can't believe its almost over.

Chapter 5: Epilogue / I Have The Answer Now

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

One incredibly gay year later.

CLICK-CLICK. CLICK-CLICK.

“Now turn a little— No not like that— There.” Catra raises the camera to her eye again.

CLICK-CLICK. CLICK-CLICK.

“Come on, Adora, you weren’t looking at the camera.”

“I’m sorry, I just can't keep my eyes off you.” Adora grins, trying her best to act suave.

“I’m gonna fucking swoon, Dor. At least vaguely look up towards the camera, or do I need to hold up a squeaky toy?”

“I can’t help but feel you didn’t really mean that, and since when have I expressed interest in squeaky toys?” Adora says, giving a pouty little frown.

“I was making a— You know what, nevermind.” She raises the camera again.

CLICK-CLICK. CLICK-CLICK.

“You’re taking this very seriously for someone who said it was, what? Absurdly embarrassing?”

“I said it would be absurdly embarrassing if anyone saw these. I happen to be a professional. Now, hold your hand out towards me. Like you’re going to grab my hand.” Catra says, demonstrating. Adora outstretches her hand and looks at Catra longingly.

CLICK-CLICK. CLICK-CLICK.

“Don’t act like you aren’t enjoying this too. Do you think I need more rose petals?” Adora asks, looking around at the bed *that does not need more rose petals.*

“You’re practically swimming in them, Dor. Let me get closer.” Catra straddles Adora’s waist, aiming the camera right at her face.

“This reminds me of a certain night.” Adora turns her head, blushing.

CLICK-CLICK. CLICK-CLICK.

“Hey! I wasn’t ready for that one.”

“Oh, so now you’re concerned with looking at the camera?”

“I wasn’t even facing you that time, that's all!” Adora says unconvincingly.

“You have a fucking beautiful profile, you know that? The light was hitting perfectly too.” Catra looks Adora straight in the eyes.

“No, I, uhm, I did not know that.” Adora breaks eye contact, glancing around, at likely all of the rose petals.

“Now you do.” Catra grins.

“You think we should put one of these on our Save the Date cards?” Adora asks with a surge of confidence that *almost* caught Catra off guard.

“It’s your funeral, American Beauty. But how can you suggest that after getting flustered when your fiancé calls you beautiful?”

“It’s, uh, different. Two different things, yeah.” Adora mumbles with rosy cheeks.

“You aren’t gonna survive kissing the bride.”

“Thats not—”

CLICK-CLICK. CLICK-CLICK.

“Hey! I was talking!”

“Ooh. Yeah, that's a keeper for sure.”

“Alright, that's it, let me see them!” Adora barrels up, knocking Catra onto her back. She quickly climbs on top of Catra trying to get at the camera.

“Adora! Stop!” Catra laughs, “Get off me!” They roll around on the bed. “You’re getting petals everywhere!” Catra reorientates onto her knees, trying to crawl away, but Adora wraps her arms around her in a grapple, her hands grabbing Catra’s stomach. “Hey, that tickles!” Catra exclaims as Adora hauls her up and onto her lap. She settles into Adora’s lap, wrapping her arms around her shoulders. Catra leans in and they share a slow, gentle kiss. “I love you.”

“I love you too.”

KNOCK! KNOCK! KNOCK!

Adora looks over to the bedroom door.

“I’d get the door, but, uh…” Adora looks down at her less than clothed body.

“As much as I’d love to watch that, I’ll get it.” Catra gets off Adora and heads to the door. When she opens it, she’s greeted by none

other than Sparkles, who opens her mouth, then pauses.

“Why are you covered in rose petals? Ugh, you aren’t even married yet you can’t be honeymooning already.”

“Oh we're not honeymooning, we're getting wedding invitation photos to send you and only you.”

“Blech! Don’t even joke about that. Is Adora here? I got her weird soda.”

“Darling~” Catra calls out, grinning. The bedroom door cracks open and Adora’s head sticks out.

“Oh! Hey, Glimmer!” Adora exclaims, surprised. She shoots Catra a look, who only smiles back.

“Ugh! I knew it. You two can’t keep it in your pants, can you?”

“Sparkles has something for you.” Catra points at Glimmer, who holds up two box shaped bags.

“Ginger beer! Thank you! They don’t have my favorite here, I hope it wasn’t too much trouble.”

“Oh, you know, just couriering soda after my vacation for my absolute lesbian disaster of a best friend.” Glimmer shrugs, “Not too much trouble.” Adora grins guiltily.

“Give me like… 60 seconds and I’ll be out there." Adora’s head quickly disappears into the bedroom.

“No, please take your time. Cover up completely, I beg you.” Glimmer calls out to Adora. But it seems Adora considered 60 seconds a personal challenge and was out much quicker. She stumbles out of the bedroom in a band shirt and shorts that say *Juicy* on the back.

“C’mon, we gotta taste ‘em since you went through all the trouble.” Adora walks over giddily, relieving Glimmer of the bags,

and setting them on the counter. As Adora is ripping into one of the boxes, Catra is grabbing three glasses from the cabinet. She sets the glasses down and Adora quickly pours some in each. Adora lifts hers up in the air.

"To my two favorite people in the world— don't tell Bow."

“To the two most stubborn people I know.” Glimmer says, raising her glass.

“To those that never gave up on me.” Catra raises her glass.

”Cheers!” they exclaim, knocking their glasses together. Catra glances between them, and smiles, raising the glass to her lips.

Chapter End Notes

> This was certainly a journey, and yes that is the end. We started in media res, and ended that way. Hopefully the knowledge of their future from this is satisfying enough. There is no more angst; they live happily ever after together, but that's all we get to know.
>
> Originally, I had planned to make this so much more angsty, like full on hate, but I couldn't do that to my girls.
>
> I do suppose I could potentially be persuaded to make a Bright-Mart prequel oneshot if there’s interest in that. I am working on a couple other fics right now though (sorry couples therapy) so it wouldn't exactly be soon but it would be on the docket. My work flow is basically just following what I feel passionate about at the moment.
>
> To those that stuck around or are reading in the future, I hope you've enjoyed my fic :)
>
> edit: i forgot i wanted to plug the playlist again!!!!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!